

WATER HEATER TEST STATION | PCB Wiring & Connection Guide

Embedded Hardware System for Control, Data Acquisition & AC Monitoring
Power Lab — Smart Grid Research & Simulation Platform, Portland State University, ECE Department

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[!] DANGER — HIGH VOLTAGE [!] Do **NOT** open this enclosure unless all power sources are de-energized. **L1 and L2 (AC mains) are present on the PCB.** Valve L1 is wired **upstream of the breaker** and remains **energized even when the WH breaker is OFF**. Before opening: turn **OFF the main panel breaker**, disconnect the **24 VDC supply**, and unplug the **Raspberry Pi USB-C power**.

Wire Colors Legend

Colored **boxes** indicate the signal type or function. Colored **arrows** represent the actual wire color used in the station wiring. Any wiring must follow this guide or be updated to match configuration changes.

AC Power

High voltage: L1 and L2 (240 VAC) or 120 VAC configuration
Includes relay switching (valve control)

Sensor Signals

4–20 mA transmitter loops

Low Voltage

24 VDC and USB-C 5 VDC

Communication

RS-485, HDMI (display), LED indicators

Neutral (N)

120 VAC return (not used in 240 VAC mode)

Used instead of L2 for 120 VAC water heater

Flow Transmitter

* WH3 & WH4 use alternate wire colors

Station Overview

Unit	Panel	Bkr	AC Config
WH1	P1	Pos.1	240V (L1–L2)
WH2	P1	Pos.3	120V (L1–N)
WH3	P2	Pos.2	240V (L1–L2)
WH4	P2	Pos.4	240V (L1–L2)

Panel Breakers: Each panel contains two breakers:
Panel 1 → WH1 and WH2 Panel 2 → WH3 and WH4.

Main Breakers: FAB-NDP1P-A (1,3) for Panel 1 FAB-NDP1P-A (2,4) for Panel 2.

Important: Turning OFF panel breakers does **NOT** de-energize the valves.
All Valves remains live.

Required for Safe Work: Disconnect panel supply cables for both panels
OR turn OFF the main breakers before any wiring changes.

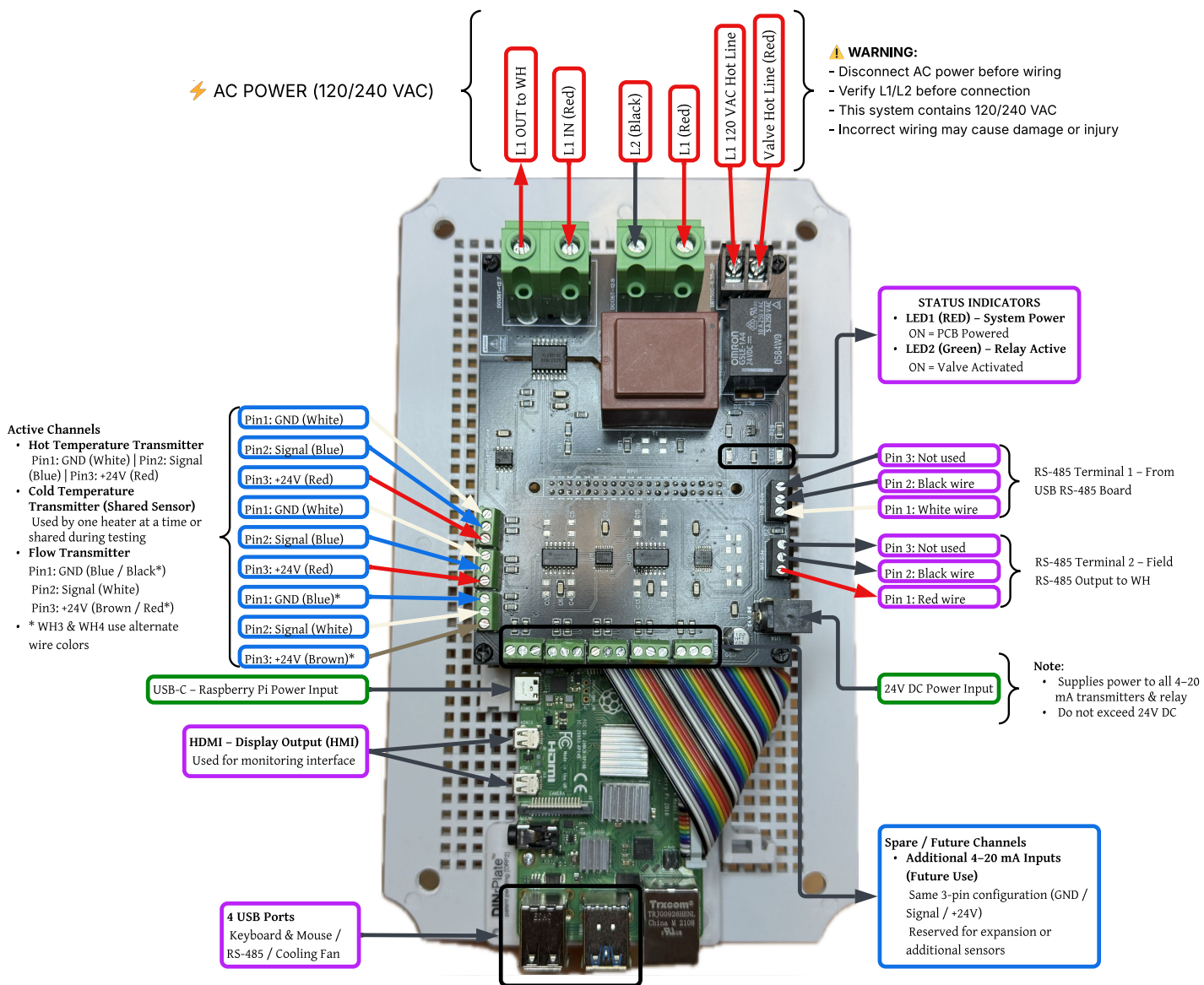
Pipe Order: Temperature Sensor (Hot) → 120 VAC Valve → Manual Valve
→ Flow Transmitter → Sink.

Voltage Configuration: System designed for 240 VAC (L1 + L2).
WH2 currently uses 120 VAC (Neutral instead of L2).
Verify wiring before any configuration change.

Status LEDs

LED	Colour	St.	Meaning
LED1	RED	ON	PCB + 4–20 mA ON
LED1	RED	OFF	No PCB power
LED2	GREEN	ON	Valve OPEN
LED2	GREEN	OFF	Valve CLOSED

PCB Connection Diagram (Annotated) — All connectors, pins, and wire colors as installed



Connector Quick Reference

4–20 mA Transmitter Terminals

Pin 1 = GND | Pin 2 = Signal | Pin 3 = +24V

Channel	P1 (GND)	P2 (Signal)	P3 (+24V)
Hot Temp. Tx	White	Blue	Red
Cold Temp. Tx (shared)	White	Blue	Red
Flow Tx WH1/WH2	Blue	White	Brown
Flow Tx WH3/WH4*	Black	White	Red
Spare (5 ch.)	—	—	—

*WH3/WH4 use alternate colours only for flow Tx — verify by pin number.

AC Power Terminals — LIVE / DE-ENERGIZE FIRST

Terminal	Wire	Note
L1 IN	Red	From panel breaker
L1 OUT to WH	Red	To water heater (via current sensing)
L2	Black	From panel breaker (240 VAC return)
N (WH2 only)	Yellow	Used only for 120 VAC water heater
Valve Hot (120V)	Red	LIVE even if panel breakers are OFF
Ground (PE)	Green	Protective earth (always connected)

RS-485 Terminals

Terminal	Pin	Wire	Note
Term. 1 (USB brd.)	1	White	A(+) from Pi
	2	Black	B(–)
Term. 2 (to WH)	1	Red	A(+) to WH field
	2	Black	B(–)

Pin 3 unused on both terminals

Low Voltage Connections

Connector	Function
USB-C	Pi power input (5V adapter)
HDMI	Display / HMI monitor output
4x USB	Keyboard, mouse, RS-485 adapter, fan
40-pin GPIO	Must match PCB pin labeling exactly
24V Barrel Jack	Sensor / PCB power (+24V, min 1.5 A)

Note: 24 VDC is supplied through the barrel jack in the station. If not available, use an external 24 VDC adapter (minimum 1.5 A).

Pi Power: Use the Raspberry Pi adapter or a stable 5 V supply.

Power-Down Procedure (Before Opening Enclosure)

1	OFF: MAIN breaker	OR disconnect panel supply cables (REQUIRED)
2	Verify with meter	Confirm 0V at all AC terminals
3	OFF: WH breaker	Additional isolation only
4	Unplug 24V adapter	LED1 should turn OFF
5	Unplug Pi USB-C	Disconnect power cable
6	Do NOT open panel	Requires qualified electrician

[!] Key Safety & Wiring Notes

- Valve L1 is pre-breaker:** remains live unless the main breaker is OFF or panel supply is disconnected.
- L1, L2, and N (WH2) are routed through the PCB. Do not touch while energized.
- Cold water transmitter is **shared** — connect to only one PCB at a time.
- LM35 ambient sensor is PCB-mounted only (not part of the pipe station).
- WH3/WH4 cable colors different. Verify by **pin number**.
- 4–20 mA check: 0.48 V to 2.40 V across 120 Ω.
- WH2 Note:** currently configured for 120 VAC (L1 + N). If changed to 240 VAC, replace N with L2 and update calibration.